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LANDMARK DEAL: Indira and Bhutto signing the Simla Agreement

◀◀ **REWIND**



There couldn't have been a better way to celebrate the silver jubilee of Independence. Fresh from a victory in the 1971 war, Indira Gandhi signed the Simla Agreement with Pakistan Prime Minister Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, aiming to "put an end to the conflict and confrontation" and maintain the line of control that resulted from the ceasefire of 1971. Bhutto promised he would persuade his people to accept its conversion into the international border. India insisted the two nations would settle their differences "by peaceful means through bilateral negotiations".

BAD TO WORSE

There were more illiterates in 1972 than there had been in 1947. Drop-out rates were very high and only a small proportion of those enrolled in universities graduated. Thanks to the various initiatives launched by the government over the years, India's literacy rate has improved by almost 50 per cent since 1947 and now stands at 61 per cent.



THE MIDDLE ORDER

Adoor Gopalakrishnan's debut feature film *Swayamvaram* (meaning one's own choice) was critically acclaimed for its depiction of the middle class and its woes realistically. Made in Malayalam, the film told the story of a couple who eloped to marry, only to face poverty and hardship. Gopalakrishnan, a former government officer-turned Film and Television Institute of India graduate, wrote his own scripts and was heralded as a master realist the world over.

FIRST CUT

● In July, Kiran Bedi became the country's first woman IPS officer and was inducted into the Delhi cadre. She later became

known for initiating prison reforms in Delhi's Tihar Jail.

● Hindustan Aeronautics produced the first agricultural aeroplane, named *Basant*.

◀◀ DID YOU KNOW

The Wildlife Preservation Act was passed to protect wild species like tigers and lions from extinction. It also banned the capture and sale of dancing bears.